

Epson Stylus C61

A clear picture

The Stylus C61 offers an excellent resolution of 5760x720 dpi and some new innovations.

It sits pretty on your desk. However, the body is made of plastic and that makes one doubt its ruggedness. It has a parallel port as well as a USB interface for faster and easier connectivity. It comes with a setup manual, driver CD, a customer contact book, a parallel printer cable and power cable. Unfortunately, a USB cable was not included in the package.

We printed a test photograph at the highest resolution on glossy photo paper—the images were printed crisp with high detail. However, the colours were not reproduced accurately—the yellow was many shades darker, while the blue was a shade lighter than in the original photograph. It took almost 10



minutes to print the test photograph in A4 size and at high resolution—normal for such printers.

The Stylus C61 printed a text page in 17 seconds, but it tended to get a bit noisy when printing documents in the economy mode or when the document contained text and graphics.

It uses Epson's QuickDry inks, which means that there are fewer chances of documents getting smudged.

The printer works on a wide variety of paper and produces excellent photo quality. However, you can get printers that achieve high levels of quality at lower costs.

SPECIFICATIONS

Piezo printing technology, 5670x720 maximum resolution, parallel and USB interface, 32 KB buffer, A4 size paper capacity, 3.5 kg weight

Price: Rs 7,495
Contact: Epson India Pvt Ltd
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Epson Stylus C61		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

Mercury HT-4500

Sound speaker

The HT-4500 is a 5.1-channel speaker set and each of the five satellites pumps out 6 watts RMS, while the subwoofer is capable of 20 W RMS power output.

The black satellite speakers are compact and

well-designed, though a tad heavy. The subwoofer has the volume and fade controls on the front, which makes it difficult to access these settings, as subwoofers are generally placed near the feet, with the front face ideally facing a reflecting surface. Another inconvenience is the power switch located at the back of the



subwoofer. Also, the cable for the front channel speakers isn't long enough for the speakers to be placed sufficiently far apart. The cable connecting the woofer to the soundcard is of the same colour, which can cause some confusion.

The speakers give a good surround sound effect with reasonable clarity for a good home theatre experience and can also be connected directly to a DVD player. The performance in the low and mid frequencies is also good. However, the speakers are not built to listen at full

Price: Rs 4,200
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volume as there is a slight distortion.

If you are looking for a no-frills speaker set that yet gives you good performance, you can put your money on the HT-4500.

SPECIFICATIONS

5.1 surround, compatible with AC-3 and DTS, DVD and 5.1-channel soundcard, 4500 W PMPO, 6 W RMS for satellites and 20 W RMS for subwoofer, 30 Hz-20 KHz frequency response, RCAX6 signal input, RCAX5 signal output.

Mercury HT-4500		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	

HP Deskjet 450Cbi

Mobile printing

The DeskJet 450Cbi is a well-designed mobile printer, weighing only 2 kg. A flap on the top exposes the control buttons and a smooth moving slider on the paper feed tray adjusts to the paper size. A Lithium Ion battery pack at the back gets charged when the AC power supply is connected through the adapter. The supplied HP DeskJet Toolbox monitors the battery as well as ink level. An infrared port, apart from parallel and USB ports, lets you print via handhelds; a slot for type II Compact Flash card allows for Bluetooth connectivity.

It produced sharp text documents when we printed from a Palm handheld device.

Price: Rs 15,999
Contact: Hewlett-Packard India Ltd
Phone: 011-26826000
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Web site: www.hpindia.com



When printing via laptop, the quality was good but took a long 25 seconds. The clarity in the combined text and photograph document was superb and even the details on the small photographs were clearly visible. It failed to print photographs at the highest resolution on non-HP photo paper. Though not as good as other inkjets, it is a good buy for those who need to print on the move.

SPECIFICATIONS

9 ppm black printouts, 8 ppm colour printouts, fast Infrared, parallel and USB interface, up to 4800 dpi optimised dpi in colour text printing

HP Deskjet 450Cbi		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Build Quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶	